

MANDATORY WORKPLACE POLICY



DOCUMENT CONTROL

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APPROVALS

Action	Name	Designation	Date
Prepared	Zain Schine Aldaba Mark Patena Paul Catipay	Benefits Associate Compliance Officer Compliance Officer	
Reviewed	Apple Loraine Mag-usara Dolley Campugan Jude Michael David		
Approved	Anthony Aragon	Human Resource Director	
Approved	Giovanni Yap	Executive Director	

REVISION HISTORY

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1	1.0	-		Conceptualization

Objective

EmpireOne provides safe workspaces in compliance with all applicable Philippine labor regulations

Scope

The policy is applicable to all EmpireOne Philippines employees

SMOKE-FREE WORKPLACE POLICY AND PROGRAM

Pursuant to Section 6 of Republic Act No. 9211 which specifically prohibits indoor smoking and protects people against second hand smoke, this company policy is hereby issued to protect its employees and clients against the hazard brought about by smoking.

Smoke-free workplaces protect non-smokers from the dangers of secondhand smoke and also encourage staff to either quit smoking or reduce their cigarette consumption. Successful implementation of this policy will depend on both the management and employees support.

I. PREVENTIVE STRATEGIES

EmpireOne shall notify all employees of this policy and shall establish a smoke-free workplace policy awareness program. This will also be a part of orientation for newly-hired employees. A **“NO SMOKING SIGN”** shall be conspicuously displayed at floor areas which were designated as a NO SMOKING AREA. The roof top and the parking area are the only areas in the office in which employees will be allowed to smoke.

Capacity building for speakers' bureau, counsellors and the general workers population will be part of staff development program of EmpireOne.

The ill-effects of smoking will be discussed during the training/orientation of employees which will be spearheaded by the Health and Safety Committee.

II. IMPLEMENTATION

Worksite smoking policies aim mainly to protect non-smokers from Environmental Tobacco Smoke, (ETS), while the objective of worksite cessation program is to help employees who do smoke to give up the habit. The use of support groups of former smokers, HRDS staff, and medical staff that may act as educators/counsellors and support for workers to enable them in their wish of quitting the habit. Programs should be coordinated with managed-care providers' offerings of tobacco assessment and counselling. Internally, physical activity, nutrition, and stress management will assist smokers to quit and to stay abstinent.

Networking with health professionals, experts and organizations with the same advocacy is also being encouraged to create a partnership of sort. This may lead to better program implementation as their best practices may be replicated.

Strengthening workers participation may encourage ownership of the program. Team Leaders per Department maybe assigned, he/she may assign secret marshals who would monitor the no smoking policy in their workplaces. Team leaders would also monitor the smoker's diary (mandatory to smokers enrolled

in the program) and the progress of the implementation of the smoking program in their office.

Employees who wish to quit smoking shall be referred by the committee to DOH accredited smoking cessation clinics.

III. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The implementation of the smoke-free workplace policies and programs shall be monitored and evaluated periodically by the employer to ensure that the goal of an alcohol-free workplace is met. The Health and Safety Committee or other similar Committee shall be tasked for this purpose.

TUBERCULOSIS (TB) PREVENTION AND CONTROL

EmpireOne BPO Solutions, Inc. recognizes that while 80% of Tuberculosis (TB) cases belong to the economically productive individuals, it is also treatable and its spread can be curtailed if proper control measures will be implemented. As such, this TB Policy and Program is hereby issued for the information and guidance of the employees.

PURPOSE:

To address the stigma attached to TB and to ensure that the worker's right against discrimination, brought by the disease, is protected.

To facilitate free access to anti-TB medicines of affected employees through referrals.

I. IMPLEMENTING STRUCTURE

EmpireOne BPO Solutions, Inc. TB Program shall be managed by its health and safety committee consisting of representatives from the different divisions and departments.

II. COVERAGE

This Program shall apply to all employees regardless of their employment status.

III. GUIDELINES

A. Preventive Strategies

1. Conduct of Tuberculosis (TB) Advocacy, Training and Education

- a. TB education shall be conducted by the EmpireOne's Medical Clinic in close coordination with the health and safety committee, through distribution and posting of IEC materials and counselling and/ or lectures.
- b. Engineering measures such as improvement of ventilation, provision for adequate sanitary facilities and observance of standard for space requirement (avoidance of overcrowding) shall be implemented.

2. Screening, Diagnosis, Treatment and Referral to Health Care Services

- a. EmpireOne shall establish a referral system and provide access to diagnostic and treatment services for its employees. EmpireOne shall make arrangements with the nearest Direct Observed Treatment (DOT) facility.
- b. EmpireOne's adherence to the DOTS guidelines on the diagnosis and treatment is highly encouraged.

B. MEDICAL MANAGEMENT

1. EmpireOne shall adopt the DOTS strategy in the management of workers with tuberculosis. TB case finding, case holding and Reporting and Recording shall be in accordance with the Comprehensive Unified Policy (CUP) and the National Tuberculosis Control Program.
2. EmpireOne shall at the minimum refer employees and their family members with TB to private or public DOTS centers.

C. SOCIAL POLICY

1. Non-discriminatory Policy and Practices

- a. There shall be no discrimination of any form against employees from pre to post employment, including hiring, promotion, or assignment, on account of their TB status. (ILO C111)
- b. Workplace management of sick employees shall not differ from that of any other illness. Persons with TB related illnesses should be able to work for as long as medically fit.

2. Work-Accommodation and Arrangement

- a. Agreements made between EmpireOne and employee's representatives shall reflect measures that will support workers with TB through flexible leave arrangements, rescheduling of working time and arrangement for return to work.
- b. The employee may be allowed to return to work with reasonable working arrangements as determined by EmpireOne Health Care provider and/or the DOTS provider.

D. COMPENSATION

EmpireOne shall provide access to Social Security System and Employees Compensation benefits under PD 626 to an employee who acquired TB infection in the performance of his/her duty.

V. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF EMPLOYERS AND EMPLOYEES

A. Employer's Responsibilities

1. The Employer, together with workers/ labor organizations, company focal personnel for human resources, safety and health personnel shall develop, implement, monitor and evaluate the workplace policy and program on TB.
1. Provide information, education and training on TB prevention for its workforce.
2. Ensure non-discriminatory practices in the workplace.
3. Ensure confidentiality of the health status of its employees and the access to medical records is limited to authorized personnel.
4. The Employer, through its Human Resources Department, shall see to it that their company policy and program is adequately funded and made known to all employees.
5. The Health and Safety Committee, together with employees/ labor organizations shall jointly review the policy and program and continue to improve these by networking with government and organizations promoting TB prevention.

B. Employees' Responsibilities

1. The employee's organization is required to undertake an active role in educating and training their members on TB prevention and control.
2. Employees shall practice non-discriminatory acts against co-workers.
3. Employees and their organization shall not have access to personnel data relating to a worker's TB status.
4. Employees shall comply with universal precaution and the preventive measures.

V. IMPLEMENTATION AND MONITORING

The Safety and Health Committee or its counterpart shall periodically monitor and evaluate the implementation of this Policy and Program.

ANTI-SEXUAL HARASSMENT POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

Pursuant to the provisions of Section 4, Republic Act No. 7877, *An Act Declaring Sexual Harassment Unlawful in the Employment, Education or Training Environment, and For Other Purposes*, the following policies and procedure are hereby issued by EmpireOne Company to prevent sexual harassment in its workplace and to provide the procedure for the resolution, settlement and/or disposition of sexual harassment cases.

I. COMPANY POLICY AGAINST SEXUAL HARASSMENT

EmpireOne believes that employees should be afforded the opportunity to work in an environment free of sexual harassment. Sexual harassment is a form of misconduct that undermines the employment relationship. No employee, either male or female, should be subjected verbally or physically to unsolicited and unwelcome sexual overtures or conduct.

Sexual harassment refers to behavior that is not welcome, that is personally offensive, debilitates morale and, therefore, interferes with work effectiveness. Such behavior may be in the form of unwanted physical, verbal or visual sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other sexually oriented conduct which is offensive or objectionable to the recipient, including, but not limited to: epithets, derogatory or suggestive comments, slurs or gestures and offensive posters, cartoons, pictures, or drawings.

EmpireOne will not tolerate any behavior that amounts to sexual harassment and any officer or employee found to have committed sexual harassment shall be subjected to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

A. DEFINITION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT

EmpireOne has adopted, and its policy is based on, the definition of sexual harassment set forth in Section 3 of R.A. 7877. It provides that sexual harassment in workplace is committed by an employer, employee, manager, supervisor, agent of the employer, or any other person who, having authority, influence or moral ascendancy over another in a work environment, demands, requires or otherwise requires any sexual favor from the other, regardless of whether the demand, requests or requirement for submission is accepted by the object of said Act.

In a work-related or employment environment, sexual harassment is committed when:

1. The sexual favor is made as a condition in the hiring or in the employment, re-employment, or continued employment of said individual, or in granting said individual favorable compensation, terms of conditions, promotions, or privileges; or the refusal to grant the sexual favor results in limiting, segregating or classifying the employee which in any way would discriminate, deprive or diminish employment opportunities or otherwise adversely affect said employee;
2. the above acts would impair the employees' rights or privileges under existing labor laws; or
3. the above acts would result in an intimidating, hostile, or offensive environment for the employee.

B. WHERE SEXUAL HARASSMENT IS COMMITTED

Sexual harassment may be committed in any work or training environment. It may include, but are not limited to the following:

1. In or outside the office building or training site;
2. at office or training-related social functions;
3. in the course of work assignments outside the office;

4. at work-related conferences, studies or training sessions; or
5. during work related travel.

C. FORMS OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT

Sexual harassment may be committed in any of the following forms:

1. Overt sexual advances;
2. Unwelcome or improper gestures of affection;
3. Request or demand for sexual favors including but not limited to going out on dates, outings, or the like for the same purpose;
4. Any other act or conduct of a sexual nature or for purposes of sexual gratification which is generally annoying, disgusting or offensive to the victim.

D. WHAT IS NOT SEXUAL HARASSMENT

Sexual harassment does not refer to occasional compliments of a socially acceptable nature. It refers to behavior that is not welcome, that is personally offensive, that debilitates morale, and that, therefore, interferes with work effectiveness.

E. EMPLOYER'S RESPONSIBILITY

EmpireOne undertakes to provide its officers and employees a work environment free of sexual harassment by management personnel, by co-workers and by others with whom officers and employees must interact in the course of their employment in EmpireOne. Sexual harassment is specifically prohibited as unlawful and as a violation of EmpireOne's policy. EmpireOne is responsible for preventing sexual harassment in the workplace, for taking immediate corrective action to stop sexual harassment in the workplace and for promptly investigating any allegation of work-related sexual harassment.

II. PROCEDURES ON SEXUAL HARASSMENT CASES

A. COMPLAINT PROCEDURE

Any officer or employee, who experiences or witnesses any act of sexual harassment in the workplace, shall report the same immediately to the Committee on Decorum and Investigation. They may also report acts of sexual harassment to any other member of EmpireOne's management or ownership. All allegations of sexual harassment will be quickly investigated. To the extent possible, the identity of the officer or employee shall remain confidential and that of any witnesses and the alleged harasser will be protected against unnecessary disclosure. When the investigation is completed, all parties will be informed of the outcome of the investigation.

A Committee on Decorum and Investigation shall be constituted and shall be composed of the management and the employees' representative to receive complaints, investigate and hear sexual harassment cases. The Committee shall develop its own rules in the settlement and disposition of sexual harassment cases. The Committee shall also develop and implement programs to increase understanding and awareness about sexual harassment.

B. RETALIATION

EmpireOne will permit no employment-based retaliation against anyone who brings a complaint of sexual harassment or who speaks as a witness in the investigation of a complaint of sexual harassment.

C. WRITTEN POLICY

All officers and employees of EmpireOne shall receive a copy of sexual harassment policy upon assumption of their respective offices. If at any time an officer or employee would like another copy of the policy, please contact the Office of the Committee on Decorum. If EmpireOne should amend or modify its sexual harassment policy, all officers and employees will receive an individual copy of the amended or modified policy.

HIV/AIDS WORKPLACE POLICY AND PROGRAM

In conformity with Republic Act No. 8504 otherwise known as the Philippine AIDS Prevention and Control Act of 1998 which recognizes workplace-based programs as a potent tool in addressing HIV/AIDS as an international pandemic problem, this company policy is hereby issued for the information and guidance of the employees in the diagnosis, treatment and prevention of HIV/AIDS in the workplace.

This policy is also aimed at addressing the stigma attached to HIV/AIDS and ensures that the workers' right against discrimination and confidentiality is maintained.

I. IMPLEMENTING STRUCTURE

EmpireOne HIV/AIDS Program shall be managed by its health and safety committee consisting of representatives from the different divisions and departments.

II. BASIC INFORMATION ON HIV/AIDS

What is HIV/AIDS?

It is a disease caused by a virus called HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus). This virus slowly weakens a person's ability to fight off other diseases by attaching itself to and destroying important cells that control and support the human immune system.

How HIV/AIDS is transmitted?

- Unprotected sex with an HIV infected person;
- From an infected mother to her child (during pregnancy, at birth through breast feeding);
- Intravenous drug use with contaminated needles;
- Transfusion with infected blood and blood products; and
- Unsafe, unprotected contact with infected blood and bleeding wounds of an infected person.

Is there a cure?

No. However, there are antiretroviral drug combinations that are available when properly used, resulting in prolonged survival of people with HIV. **Holistic care of** people living with HIV-AIDS and comprehensive treatment of opportunistic infections also dramatically improve quality of life.

III. COVERAGE

This Program shall apply to all employees regardless of their employment status.

IV. GUIDELINES

A. Preventive Strategies

1. Conduct of HIV-AIDS Education.-

a. Who will conduct?

The Medical Clinic of EmpireOne in coordination with the Health and Safety Committee shall conduct HIV-AIDS education to all employees for free. This shall also form part of the orientation of newly hired employees. The standardized information package developed by the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) may be used for this purpose.

b. How will it be conducted?

The HIV-AIDS education will be conducted through distribution and posting of IEC materials, lectures, counselling and training and information on adherence to standard or universal precautions in the workplace

2. Screening, Diagnosis, Treatment and Referral to Health Care Services

- a. Screening for HIV as a prerequisite to employment is not mandatory.
- b. EmpireOne shall encourage positive health seeking behavior through Voluntary Counseling and Testing.
- c. EmpireOne shall establish a referral system and provide access to diagnostic and treatment services for its workers. Referral to Social Hygiene Clinics of LGU for HIV screening shall be facilitated by EmpireOne's medical clinic staff.
- d. EmpireOne shall likewise facilitate access to livelihood assistance for the affected employee and his/her families, being offered by other government agencies.

B. SOCIAL POLICY

1. Non-discriminatory Policy and Practices

- a. Discrimination in any form from pre-employment to post-employment, including hiring, promotion or assignment, termination of employment based on the actual, perceived or suspected HIV status of an individual is prohibited.
- b. Workplace management of sick employees shall not differ from that of any other illness.
- c. Discriminatory acts done by an officer or an employee against their co-officer or co-employee shall likewise be penalized.

2. Confidentiality/Non-Disclosure Policy

- a. Access to personal data relating to a worker's HIV status shall be bound by the rules of confidentiality consistent with provisions of R.A. 8504 and the ILO Code of Practice.
- b. Job applicants and workers shall not be compelled to disclose their HIV/AIDS status and other related medical information.
- c. Co-employees shall not be obliged to reveal any personal information relating to the HIV/AIDS status of fellow workers.

3. Work-Accommodation and Arrangement

- a. EmpireOne shall take measures to reasonably accommodate employees with AIDS related illnesses.
- b. Agreements made between EmpireOne and employee representatives shall reflect measures that will support workers with HIV/AIDS through flexible leave arrangements, rescheduling of working time and arrangement for return to work.

IV. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF EMPLOYERS AND EMPLOYEES

A. Employer's Responsibilities

1. EmpireOne, together with employees/ labor organizations, company focal personnel for human resources, safety and health personnel shall develop, implement, monitor and evaluate the workplace policy and program on HIV/AIDS.
2. Provide information, education and training on HIV/AIDS for its workforce.
3. Ensure non-discriminatory practices in the workplace and that the policy and program adheres to existing legislations and guidelines.
4. Ensure confidentiality of the health status of its employees and the access to medical records is limited to authorized personnel.
5. EmpireOne, through its Human Resources Department, shall see to it that their company policy and program is adequately funded and made known to all employees.
6. The Health and Safety Committee, together with employees/ labor organizations shall jointly review the policy and program and continue to improve these by networking with government and organizations promoting HIV prevention.

B. Employees' Responsibilities

1. The employee's organization shall undertake an active role in educating and training their members on HIV prevention and control. Promote and practice a healthy lifestyle with emphasis on avoiding high risk behavior and other risk factors that expose workers to increased risk of HIV infection.
2. Employees shall practice non-discriminatory acts against co-employees.
3. Employees and their organization shall not have access to personnel data relating to a worker's HIV status.
4. Employees shall comply with universal precaution and preventive measures.

V. IMPLEMENTATION AND MONITORING

The Safety and Health Committee or its counterpart shall periodically monitor and evaluate the implementation of this Policy and Program.

WORKPLACE POLICY AND PROGRAM ON HEPATITIS B

EmpireOne is committed to conform to the established standards of assurance of customer satisfaction, protection of our environment and health and safety in the workplaces.

EmpireOne promotes and ensures a healthy environment through its various health programs to safeguard its employees. And as part of EmpireOne's compliance to DOLE Department Advisory No. 05, Series of 2010 (Guidelines for the Implementation of a Workplace Policy and Program on Hepatitis B), this Program has been developed. This program is aimed to address the stigma attached to hepatitis B and to ensure that the employees' right against discrimination and confidentiality is maintained.

This guideline is formulated for everybody's information and reference for the diagnosis, treatment, and prevention of Hepatitis B. This will inform the employees of their role as well as EmpireOne in dealing with Hepatitis B. A healthy environment encompasses a good working relationship and great output for continuous business growth.

I. Implementing Structure

EmpireOne's Hepatitis B workplace policy and program shall be managed by its health and safety committee. Each division or department of EmpireOne shall be duly represented.

II. Guidelines

A. Education

1. Coverage. All employees regardless of employment status may avail of hepatitis B education services for free;
2. Hepatitis B shall be conducted through distribution and posting of IEC materials and counselling and/ or lectures; and
3. Hepatitis B education shall be spearheaded by the EmpireOne Medical Clinic in close coordination with the health and safety committee.

B. Preventive Strategies

1. All employees are encouraged to be immunized against Hepatitis B after securing clearance from their physician.
2. Workplace sanitation and proper waste management and disposal shall be monitored by the health and safety committee on a regular basis.
3. Personal protective equipment shall be made available at all times for all employees; and
4. Employees will be given training and information on adherence to standards or universal precautions in the workplace.

III. Social Policy

A. Non discriminatory Policy and Practices

1. There shall be no discrimination of any form against employees on the basis of their Hepatitis B status consistent with the international agreements on non discrimination ratified by the Philippines (ILO C111). Employees shall not be discriminated against, from pre to post employment, including hiring, promotion, or assignment because of their hepatitis B status.
2. Workplace management of sick employees shall not differ from that of any other illness. Persons with Hepatitis B related illnesses may work for as long as they are medically fit to work.

B. Confidentiality

Job applicants and employees shall not be compelled to disclose their Hepatitis B status and other related medical information. Co-employees shall not be obliged to reveal any personal information about their fellow employees. Access to personal data relating to an employee's Hepatitis B status shall be bound by the rules on confidentiality and shall be strictly limited to medical personnel or if legally required.

C. Work-Accommodation and Arrangement

1. EmpireOne shall take measures to reasonably accommodate employees who are Hepatitis B positive or with Hepatitis B - related illnesses.
2. Through agreements made between management and employees' representatives, measures to support employees with Hepatitis B are encouraged to work through flexible leave arrangements, rescheduling of working time and arrangements for return to work.

D. Screening, Diagnosis, Treatment and Referral to Health Care Services

1. EmpireOne shall establish a referral system and provide access to diagnostic and treatment services for its employees for appropriate medical evaluation/ monitoring and management.
2. Adherence to the guidelines for healthcare providers on the evaluation of Hepatitis B positive employees is highly encouraged.
3. Screening for Hepatitis B as a prerequisite to employment shall not be mandatory.

E. Compensation

EmpireOne shall provide access to Social Security System and Employees Compensation benefits under PD 626 to an employee contracted with Hepatitis B infection in the performance of his duty.

IV. Roles and Responsibilities of Employers and Employees

A. Employer's Responsibilities

1. Management, together with employees' organizations, company focal personnel for human resources, and safety and health personnel shall develop, implement, monitor and evaluate the workplace policy and program on Hepatitis B.

2. The Health and Safety Committee shall ensure that their company policy and program is adequately funded and made known to all employees.
3. The Human Resources Department shall ensure that their policy and program adheres to existing legislations and guidelines, including provisions on leaves, benefits and insurance.
4. Management shall provide information, education and training on Hepatitis B for its workforce consistent with the standardized basic information package developed by the Hepatitis B TWG; if not available within the establishment, then provide access to information.
5. EmpireOne shall ensure non-discriminatory practices in the workplace.
6. The management together with EmpireOne focal personnel for human resources and safety and health shall provide appropriate personal protective equipment to prevent Hepatitis B exposure, especially for employees exposed to potentially contaminated blood or body fluid.
7. The Health and Safety Committee, together with the employees' organizations shall jointly review the policy and program for effectiveness and continue to improve these by networking with government and organizations promoting Hepatitis B prevention.
8. EmpireOne shall ensure confidentiality of the health status of its employees, including those with Hepatitis B.
9. The human resources shall ensure that access to medical records is limited to authorized personnel.

B. Employees Responsibilities

1. The employees' organization is required to undertake an active role in educating and training their members on Hepatitis B prevention and control. The IEC program must also aim at promoting and practicing a healthy lifestyle with emphasis on avoiding high risk behavior and other risk factors that expose employees to increased risk of Hepatitis B infection, consistent with the standardized basic information package developed by the Hepatitis B TWG.
2. Employees shall practice non-discriminatory acts against co-employees on the ground of Hepatitis B status.
3. Employees and their organizations shall not have access to personnel data relating to an employee's Hepatitis B status. The rules of confidentiality shall apply in carrying out union and organization functions.
4. Employees shall comply with the universal precaution and the preventive measures.
5. Employees with Hepatitis B may inform the health care provider or EmpireOne physician on their Hepatitis B status, that is, if their work activities may increase the risk of Hepatitis B infection and transmission or put the Hepatitis B positive at risk for aggravation.

V. IMPLEMENTATION AND MONITORING

Within the establishment, the implementation of the policy and program shall be monitored and evaluated periodically. The safety and health committee or its counterpart shall be tasked for this purpose.

DRUG-FREE WORKPLACE POLICY AND PROGRAM

In compliance with Article V of Republic Act No. 9165, otherwise known as the Comprehensive Dangerous Drugs Act of 2002, and its Implementing Rules and Regulations and DOLE Department Order No. 53-03, series of 2003 (Guidelines for the Implementation of a Drug-Free Workplace Policies and Programs for the Private Sector), **EmpireOne** hereby adopts the following policies and programs to achieve a drug-free workplace:

I. COMPANY POLICY ON DRUG-FREE WORKPLACE

EmpireOne explicitly prohibits:

- The use, possession, solicitation for, or sale of dangerous drugs on company premises or while performing an assignment.
- Being impaired or under the influence of dangerous drugs away from EmpireOne, if such impairment or influence adversely affects the employee's work performance, the safety of the employee or of others, or puts at risk EmpireOne's reputation.
- Possession, use, solicitation for, or sale of dangerous drugs away from EmpireOne premises, if such activity or involvement adversely affects the employee's work performance, the safety of the employee or of others, or puts at risk EmpireOne's reputation.
- The presence of any detectable amount of dangerous drugs in the employee's system while at work, while on the premises of EmpireOne, or while on company business. "Dangerous Drugs" include those listed in the Schedules annexed to the 1961 Single Convention on Narcotic Drugs, as amended by the 1972 Protocol, and in the Schedules annexed to the 1971 Single Convention on Psychotropic Substances as enumerated in the attached annex of R.A. 9165.

II. COMPANY PROGRAM ON DRUG-FREE WORKPLACE

A. MANDATORY DRUG TEST

1. To ensure that only those qualified shall be screened and recruited to prevent the detrimental effects (*e.g. lower productivity; poor decision making; increased accidents; more compensation claims; and reduced team effort*) which drug use and abuse may cause in the workplace, the conduct of mandatory drug test shall be required for pre-employment.
2. EmpireOne designates a duly accredited drug testing center by the Department of Health (DOH), as its authorized drug testing laboratory.
3. EmpireOne may also conduct drug testing under any of the following circumstances:
 - i. **RANDOM TESTING:** Management Personnel/Employees may be selected at random for drug testing at any interval determined by EmpireOne.
 - ii. **FOR-CAUSE TESTING:** EmpireOne may require Management Personnel/Employee to submit to a drug test at any time it feels that the employee may be under the influence of drugs, including, but not limited to, the following circumstances: evidence of drugs on or about the employee's person or in the employee's vicinity, unusual conduct on the employee's part that suggests impairment or influence of drugs, negative performance patterns, or excessive and unexplained absenteeism or tardiness.
 - iii. **POST-ACCIDENT TESTING:** Any Management Personnel/Employee involved in a "Near-Miss" incident or "Work Accident" under circumstances that suggest possible use or influence of drugs may be asked to submit to a drug test. As defined herein, "Near-Miss" means an incident arising from or in the course of work which could have led to injuries or fatalities of the workers and/or considerable damage to the employer had it not been curtailed. "Work Accident" refers to unplanned or unexpected occurrence that may or may not result in personal injury, property damage, work stoppage or interference or any combination thereof of which arises out of and in the course of employment.
4. All drug tests shall employ, among others, two (2) testing methods, the screening test which will determine the positive result as well as the type of the drug used and the confirmatory test which will confirm a positive screening test. Where the confirmatory test turns positive, EmpireOne's Assessment Team shall evaluate the results and determine the level of care and administrative interventions that can be extended to the concerned employee.

5. EmpireOne shall inform the Management Personnel/Employee who were subjected to a drug test of the test-results whether positive or negative.
6. All costs of drug testing shall be borne by EmpireOne.

B. TREATMENT, REHABILITATION, AND REFERRAL

1. A Management Personnel/Employee who is found positive for drug use for the first time shall be referred for treatment and/or rehabilitation at a DOH-accredited center. For this purpose, EmpireOne shall provide a list of at least three (3) accredited facilities from which the individual may choose.
2. Following rehabilitation, EmpireOne's Assessment Team, in consultation with the head of the rehabilitation center, shall evaluate the status of the drug dependent employee and recommend to the employer the resumption of the employee's job if he/she poses no serious danger to his/her co-employees and/or the workplace.
3. All costs for the treatment and rehabilitation of the drug dependent employee shall be charged to his account. The period during which the employee is under treatment or rehabilitation shall be considered as authorized leaves.
4. Repeated drug use even after ample opportunity for treatment and rehabilitation shall be dealt with the corresponding penalties under R.A. 9165 and is a ground for dismissal.

C. ADVOCACY, EDUCATION AND TRAINING

1. EmpireOne undertakes to increase the awareness and education of its officers and employees on the adverse effects of dangerous drugs through continuous advocacy, education and training programs/activities to all its officers and employees.
2. All Management Personnel/Employees are required to undergo an orientation/education program before assumption of their respective duties. The program shall include the following topics:
 - i. Salient features of R.A. 9165;
 - ii. Adverse effects of abuse and/or misuse of dangerous drugs on the person, workplace, family and the community;
 - iii. Preventive measures against drug abuse; and
 - iv. Steps to take when intervention is needed, as well as available services for treatment and rehabilitation.
3. To encourage all Management Personnel/Employees to lead a healthy lifestyle while at work and at home, EmpireOne undertakes to conduct the following activities as often as possible:
 - i. Lifestyle assessment programs on health nutrition, weight management, stress management, alcohol abuse, smoking cessation, and other indicators of risk diseases;
 - ii. Health wellness screenings (*e.g. blood pressure and heart rate, cholesterol test, blood glucose, etc.*);
 - iii. Sports, recreational and fun-game activities; and
 - iv. Other activities promoting health and wellness.

D. ROLES, RIGHTS AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF EMPLOYER AND EMPLOYEES

1. EmpireOne shall ensure that the workplace policies and programs on the prevention and control of dangerous drugs, including drug testing, shall be disseminated to all officers and employees. The employer shall obtain a written acknowledgement from the employees that the policy has been read and understood by them.

2. EmpireOne shall maintain the confidentiality of all information relating to drug tests or to the identification of drug users in the workplace; exceptions may be made only where required by law, in case of overriding public health and safety concerns; or where such exceptions have been authorized in writing by the person concerned.
3. All Management Personnel/Employee shall enjoy the right to due process, absence of which will render the referral procedure ineffective.

E. CONSEQUENCES OF POLICY VIOLATIONS

1. Any Management Personnel/Employee who uses, possesses, distributes, sells or attempts to sell, tolerates, or transfers dangerous drugs or otherwise commits other unlawful acts as defined under Article II of RA 9165 and its Implementing Rules and Regulations shall be subject to the pertinent provisions of the said Act.
2. Any Management Personnel/Employee found positive for use of dangerous drugs shall be dealt with administratively in accordance with the provisions of Article 282 of Book VI of the Labor Code and under RA 9165.

F. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The implementation of these policies and programs shall be monitored and evaluated periodically by management to ensure a drug-free workplace. For this purpose, an Assessment Team shall be constituted in accordance with D.O. 53-03.

ALCOHOL-FREE WORKPLACE POLICY AND PROGRAM

EmpireOne adopts this alcohol-free workplace policy and program to ensure a safe and healthful workplace. In this regard, all employees shall abide by the terms and conditions of this policy.

I. ALCOHOL PROHIBITED

EmpireOne explicitly prohibits the following:

1. Use, possession, solicitation or sale of alcohol in the workplace; or
2. Impairment or under the influence of alcohol which may cause/causing adverse effect on employee's work performance, safety of co-employees or Company's reputation.

II. DEFINITION OF TERMS

1. Assessment Team- A group of persons composed of occupational safety and health personnel, human resource manager, employer's representative and employees' representative who are trained to address all aspects of prevention.
2. Cause Testing- A form of alcohol-test assessment conducted by EmpireOne when an employee is suspected to be under the influence of alcohol. EmpireOne request its suspected employee to submit himself to alcohol test.
3. "Involved in an on-the-job accident or injury"- An accident of any person within the workplace immediately or proximately caused by the employee under the influence of alcohol.
4. Near Miss- An incident which could have led to any injury or fatality of employees and/or considerable damage to the employer had it not been curtailed.
5. Post-Accident Testing- A form of alcohol-test assessment conducted by EmpireOne to those employees involved in an on the job accident or injury.
6. Random Testing- A form of alcohol test assessment conducted by EmpireOne Employees may be selected at random for alcohol testing at any interval determined by EmpireOne.

7. Workplace – Any office or property owned, leased or operated by EmpireOne or at any other place where an employee performs work for EmpireOne.

III. PREVENTIVE MEASURES

EmpireOne shall post in conspicuous place and notify in writing all its employees of this policy and shall establish an alcohol-free workplace policy awareness program. The contents of such awareness program are as follows:

1. Dangers involved in the use, possession, solicitation or sale of alcohol in the workplace;
2. Policy of maintaining an alcohol-free workplace;
3. Available employee assistance program; and
4. Imposable penalties for employees found guilty for violation of alcohol-free workplace policy.

IV. TESTING PROCEDURE

A. Cause-Test

1. If an employee's demeanor caused EmpireOne to suspect that he is using, possessing, soliciting or selling alcohol in the workplace, the latter will request the former to submit himself to a cause-test. If the employee objects to subject himself to cause-test, he must state his objection and the reason thereof in writing. EmpireOne shall immediately decide whether the ground for objection is valid or not. Should EmpireOne found that the objection is not valid and the employee still refused to submit himself to the cause-test, the refusal will be considered as a ground for disciplinary action; and
2. If the cause-test showed a positive result, the employee will be referred to the assessment team for further examination. However, if the employee still disagrees with the result of the assessment team, he will be subjected to another alcohol testing at the nearest medical facility.

B. Post Accident-Test

1. If an accident or a near miss has been immediately or proximately caused by employees engaged in using possessing, soliciting or selling alcohol in the workplace, all employees involved in the on the job accident shall be subjected to a post accident-test. If the employee objects to subject himself to cause-test, he must state his objection and the reason thereof in writing. EmpireOne shall immediately decide whether the ground for objection is valid or not. Should EmpireOne found that the objection is not valid and the employee still refused to submit himself to the cause-test, the refusal will be considered as a ground for disciplinary action; and
2. If the cause-test showed a positive result, the employee will be referred to the assessment team for further examination. The findings of the assessment team shall be considered final.

C. Random Test

1. At any time during the working hours, EmpireOne may conduct a random alcohol test with its employees. If the employee objects to subject himself to cause-test, he must state his objection and the reason thereof in writing. EmpireOne shall immediately decide whether the ground for objection is valid or not. Should EmpireOne found that the objection is not valid and the employee still refused to submit himself to the cause-test, the refusal will be considered as a ground for disciplinary action; and
2. If the cause-test showed a positive result, the employee will be referred to the assessment team for further examination. However, if the employee still disagrees with the result of the assessment team, he will be subjected to another alcohol testing at the nearest medical facility.

V. CONFIDENTIALITY

EmpireOne shall observe at all times confidentiality of the results relative to alcohol tests done to employees.

VI. TREATMENT, REHABILITATION AND REFERREAL

The Assessment Team shall determine whether or not an employee found addicted to alcohol would need referral for treatment and/or rehabilitation in a Department of Health-Accredited Center. This benefit is only given to employees who seek help from the assessment team.

VII. MONITORING AND EVALUATION

The implementation of the alcohol-free workplace policy and program shall be monitored and evaluated periodically by the Assessment Team to ensure that the goal of an alcohol-free workplace is met.

VIII. DISCIPLINARY ACTION

1. Failure to submit to cause-test, post accident-test, random-test, or alcohol test by a nearest medical facility shall be a ground for a disciplinary action with a penalty of one (1) month suspension without pay;
2. If an employee found guilty for violation of any of the acts prohibited under paragraph I of this policy shall be subjected to a disciplinary action with a penalty of one (1) month suspension without pay; or
3. If an employee found to have been guilty for violation of this policy, repeatedly violated the provisions thereof shall be subjected to a disciplinary action with a penalty of three (3) months suspension or dismissal from service.

Mental Health Program

A. Policy Statement

EmpireOne is committed to the mental health and well-being of its employees. Recognizing the vital role mental health plays in overall well-being and productivity, EmpireOne integrates mental health initiatives into all human resources, organizational development policies, and programs. EmpireOne fosters a supportive environment where employees are aware of mental health issues and are encouraged to seek assistance without fear of stigma or discrimination.

B. Objectives

1. To raise awareness and reduce the stigma and discrimination surrounding mental health in the workplace.
2. To identify workplace factors that may contribute to mental health-related challenges.
3. To organize activities that promote employees' mental health and well-being.
4. To establish support networks that offer:
 - a. Assistance for employees at risk;
 - b. Capacity-building for mental health service providers;
 - c. Access to treatment and psychosocial support for employees managing mental health conditions.

C. Strategies

1. Prevention and Promotion of Mental Health Well-being

- a. Conduct mental health assessments during recruitment, placement, and promotion to guide task assignments without discrimination.

- b. Implement ongoing mental health awareness and education programs, including:
 - Development of information, education, and communication (IEC) materials;
 - Conducting training and seminars;
 - Integrating mental health awareness into new employee orientations.
- c. Offer mental health wellness activities such as:
 - Regular stress management sessions;
 - Team-building exercises;
 - Peer counseling circles;
 - Social gatherings.

d. Provide a formal grievance-handling process to address workplace conflicts.

2. Establishment of Institutional Networks/Referral Systems

- a. Partner with government agencies (NGAs) and civil society organizations (CSOs) providing mental health services.
- b. Strengthen the capacity of in-house mental health providers.
- c. Implement a referral system for employees requiring mental health services.

3. Review of Workplace Conditions

- a. Regularly assess workplace environments and conditions.
- b. Evaluate workload balance against performance outcomes.
- c. Review job descriptions for alignment with mental health goals.
- d. Monitor work hours to ensure employee well-being.

D. Protocols

1. Non-discrimination

Employees facing mental health challenges will not face discrimination in recruitment, promotion, or termination. As long as their condition does not impede their productivity or worsen their mental health, they are encouraged to continue working, with appropriate certification from medical professionals.

2. Return to Work

Employees who have undergone treatment or rehabilitation will be allowed to return to work with proper medical certification confirming their fitness for duty. Supervisors will make reasonable work accommodations as needed.

3. Confidentiality

All medical information and mental health records will be kept confidential and protected under applicable laws, including the Data Privacy Act.

4. Rights-based Approach

Employees will not be excluded from work opportunities, policy-making, or program implementation related to mental health. They will also have access to affordable, evidence-based mental health care and services, and be encouraged to participate in mental health advocacy.

5. Sustainability

Mental health initiatives will be integrated into EmpireOne's overall Health and Safety Program.

E. Processes

- 1. Upon initial assessment, the Human Resource Management Office (HRMO) will take appropriate actions, which may include:
 - a. Counseling services;
 - b. Referrals to licensed mental health professionals for outpatient care;
 - c. Involving family members if necessary for additional support.
- 2. Employees requiring advanced treatment will be referred to relevant medical institutions.
- 3. Employees undergoing treatment or rehabilitation may be granted leave as recommended by their physician.

4. Flexible work arrangements will be made to accommodate employees returning from treatment.
5. Continuous monitoring of the employee's performance and well-being will ensure sustainable productivity post-treatment.

F. Responsibilities

The Human Resource Office, in coordination with EmpireOne nurse and/or physician, will manage mental health activities, including:

1. Administering and monitoring the implementation of the Mental Health Program (MHP).
2. Recording and analyzing relevant data to improve the MHP.
3. Maintaining partnerships with hospitals, agencies, and mental health professionals.
4. Facilitating workplace discussions on mental health topics.
5. Staying updated on the latest mental health information and materials.
6. Assisting in incident investigations and preparing reports related to mental health.
7. Ensuring mental health programs are integrated into EmpireOne's HR initiatives.

G. Funding

The mental health program will be funded through EmpireOne's budget.

H. Monitoring and Evaluation

Quarterly monitoring will be conducted by the HR and Health & Safety Committee. The program will be reviewed periodically for improvements or necessary revisions.

WORKPLACE CANCER PREVENTION AND CONTROL

EmpireOne is committed to upholding the highest standards of workplace health and safety, environmental protection, and customer satisfaction. EmpireOne ensures a safe and supportive environment for all employees through various health programs.

This is in compliance with Republic Act 11215, the National Integrated Cancer Control Act (2019), and DOLE Labor Advisory No. 20, which outlines the implementation of the Workplace Policy and Program on Cancer Prevention and Control in the Private Sector. This includes prevention, screening, diagnosis, treatment, return to work, compensation, and social policies.

This policy establishes an inclusive, responsive, gender-sensitive, and non-discriminatory framework for cancer prevention, control, and support in the workplace. It underscores the shared responsibility of employers and employees in fostering a stigma-free and supportive environment while aligning with relevant laws to provide accessible cancer care services.

I. IMPLEMENTING STRUCTURE

EmpireOne Workplace Cancer Prevention and Control Policy and Program (CPCPP) shall be managed by the Health and Safety Committee, with representatives from various divisions and departments to ensure inclusive implementation.

II. COVERAGE

This policy applies to all employees of EmpireOne regardless of employment status. All employees are entitled to FREE access to cancer education and services.

III. POLICY GUIDELINES

1. Inclusion and Support - Through its safety and health committee, EmpireOne shall conduct awareness programs, provide health services, and offer psychosocial support for employees and their families. They shall ensure access to cancer screening, diagnosis, treatment, and care.
2. Responsiveness - The committee shall tailor programs to meet the specific needs of employees. EmpireOne shall offer social protection during emergencies or disasters.
3. Gender Sensitivity - EmpireOne shall promote gender-sensitive education on cancer prevention, risk factors, and early warning signs.
4. Non-Discrimination - EmpireOne shall provide equal employment opportunities for cancer patients and survivors. They shall eliminate stigma and discrimination in the workplace.
5. Occupational Safety and Health - The safety and health committee shall integrate cancer prevention into the Occupational Safety and Health Program. They shall minimize exposure to carcinogens and provide protective equipment.
6. Confidentiality- EmpireOne shall protect medical records and employee information in compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012.
7. Sustainability- EmpireOne shall incorporate cancer initiatives into EmpireOne's Health and Wellness Program for long-term implementation.

IV. IMPLEMENTATION MEASURES

1. Awareness and Education- EmpireOne shall conduct regular cancer education and wellness activities. It shall promote healthy lifestyles and provide support groups.
2. Capacity-Building- EmpireOne shall train employees and caregivers on cancer prevention and care.
3. Workplace Environment- EmpireOne shall provide flexible work arrangements and reintegration programs for employees with cancer. It shall ensure a safe and supportive workplace environment.
4. Early Detection and Referral- EmpireOne shall facilitate cancer screenings during annual physical examinations. It shall establish referral systems for timely diagnosis and treatment.
5. Work Arrangements and Leave- EmpireOne shall provide flexible work hours and work-from-home options for employees with cancer or their caregivers.
6. Workplace Safety. EmpireOne shall implement measures to limit exposure to cancer-causing substances and processes.

V. PROHIBITION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION

1. Equal Employment Opportunities- Employees with cancer, survivors, or their caregivers shall have equal opportunities in hiring, promotion, training, and other HR actions.
2. Anti-Discrimination Measures- Discrimination against employees with cancer, survivors, or caregivers is strictly prohibited.
3. Accountability- Violators shall be accountable under the Magna Carta for Persons with Disability (RA No. 7277) and related laws.

VI. COMPENSATION

Employees diagnosed with cancer are entitled to benefits under the Social Security System, Employees Compensation Program, and other applicable laws.

VII. ACCESS TO HEALTH CARE AND RELATED SERVICES

1. Health Promotion- The safety and health committee shall provide counseling and communication resources.

2. Screening and Diagnosis-Employees shall be provided access to primary care and diagnostic services.
3. Treatment- Access to treatments under PhilHealth Z-Benefit Packages and other health programs shall be provided.
4. PWD Benefits- Eligible employees shall be assisted in obtaining PWD IDs from local government units.

VIII. WORK ACCOMMODATIONS

Employees shall be provided flexible work arrangements, such as telecommuting, rescheduling, and other accommodations to support employees with cancer.

IX. CONFIDENTIALITY AND REPORTING

EmpireOne shall ensure the confidentiality of employee medical records under the Data Privacy Act of 2012. Likewise, employers shall submit Annual Medical Reports (AMR) to the DOLE Regional/Provincial/Field Office, detailing cancer-related activities and updates.

X. IMPLEMENTATION AND MONITORING

The Health and Safety Committee shall monitor and evaluate the implementation of this policy and program regularly.

Heat Stress Prevention and Control

The Department of Labor and Employment recently issued Labor Advisory No. 08, Series of 2023, (“**Advisory**”) which shall cover all employers and workplaces in the private sector and their workers. This was issued to ensure the safety and health of workers exposed to extreme heat, pursuant to Article 168 of the Labor Code, as renumbered.

A. Safety and Health Measures

EmpireOne will ensure to provide safety and health measures to mitigate extreme heat at work:

1. Assess the risk of exposure of workers to extreme heat vis-à-vis their existing comorbidities (e.g., hypertension and kidney diseases) and implement appropriate control measures such as:
 - Elimination of heat and humidity in workplaces through effective ventilation and heat insulation in all areas with workers;
 - Adjustment of rest breaks or work locations to allow recovery from heat exposure;
 - Provision of temperature-appropriate uniforms and personal protective equipment in the form of hats, goggles with protection against ultraviolet rays or comfortable light material long-sleeve t-shirts; and
 - Provision of free and adequate drinking water at the workplace with a directive for drinking at least 2 to 3 liters daily.
2. Implement, based on workplace assessment, information and advocacy campaigns on symptoms and how to address heat stress.
3. Establish procedures and information networks to address heat-related emergencies.

B. Flexible Work Arrangement

The employers and the workers agree to adopt a flexible work arrangement to limit exposure to extreme heat and strenuous activities, by adjusting the work hours while maintaining the total number of work hours within the day or week until such time that the weather condition has improved.

Food and Waterborne Disease Prevention and Control

Purpose:

EmpireOne is committed to ensuring a safe and healthy workplace. This policy aims to prevent and control food and waterborne diseases among employees by promoting proper hygiene, safe food handling, and clean water practices.

Scope:

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and visitors within company premises.

Policy Guidelines:

1. Personal Hygiene

- Employees must practice proper handwashing before eating, preparing food, or handling water.
- Employees showing symptoms of food or waterborne illness (e.g., vomiting, diarrhea, fever) should report to HR or the company clinic and avoid handling food or shared equipment.

2. Safe Food Handling

- All food provided or prepared on-site must follow proper storage, preparation, and cooking procedures.
- Perishable food should be stored at safe temperatures and discarded if expired or spoiled.

3. Safe Drinking Water

- Only potable water approved by health authorities should be consumed or used in food preparation.
- Water dispensers and storage facilities must be cleaned and sanitized regularly.

4. Reporting and Control Measures

- Employees must immediately report any suspected cases of food or waterborne illness.
- The company will coordinate with health authorities to investigate and control outbreaks.

5. Training and Awareness

- Employees involved in food handling will receive training on hygiene, sanitation, and disease prevention.
- Regular reminders and awareness campaigns will be conducted to promote safe practices.

Responsibilities:

- Employees are responsible for following hygiene and safety practices.
- Supervisors and managers are responsible for enforcing compliance and reporting incidents.

Review:

This policy will be periodically reviewed to ensure compliance with health regulations and best practices in disease prevention.

Ergonomics in the Workplace

Purpose:

To promote employee health, safety, and productivity by minimizing the risk of musculoskeletal disorders and strain associated with prolonged computer use and sedentary work.

Scope:

This policy applies to all office-based employees, including officers, executives, managers, and staff.

Policy Guidelines:**1. Workstation Setup**

- Chairs must provide proper lumbar support and be adjustable.
- Computer monitors should be at eye level and approximately an arm's length away.
- Keyboards and mice should be positioned to allow relaxed shoulders and straight wrists.
- Feet should rest flat on the floor or on a footrest.

2. Posture and Positioning

- Employees should maintain a neutral sitting posture (back straight, shoulders relaxed).
- Avoid slouching, leaning forward, or prolonged awkward positions.

3. Breaks and Movement

- Employees are encouraged to take short breaks (e.g., 5 minutes every hour) to stretch and rest their eyes.
- Practice the 20-20-20 rule (every 20 minutes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds).

4. Equipment Use

- Use headsets for prolonged calls to avoid neck and shoulder strain.
- Adjust screen brightness and contrast to reduce eye strain.

5. Reporting Discomfort

- Employees must promptly report any discomfort, pain, or signs of strain to their supervisor or HR.
- Early intervention will be provided to prevent worsening conditions.

6. Training and Awareness

- The company will provide guidance and training on proper workstation setup and ergonomic practices.

Responsibilities:

- **Employees:** Follow ergonomic guidelines and use equipment properly.
- **Supervisors/Managers:** Ensure workstations are properly arranged and support employee well-being.
- **Company:** Provide appropriate equipment and promote a safe working environment.

Review:

This policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure compliance with occupational health and safety standards.

Lactation/Breastfeeding Policy

Purpose:

EmpireOne supports the health and well-being of nursing mothers and their infants by providing a safe, private, and supportive environment for breastfeeding or expressing breast milk in the workplace.

Scope:

This policy applies to all employees, including officers, executives, managers, and staff who are nursing mothers.

Policy Guidelines:

1. Lactation Breaks

- Nursing employees shall be provided with reasonable paid or unpaid lactation breaks in addition to regular break periods, in accordance with applicable laws.
- Break frequency and duration may vary depending on the employee's needs.

2. Lactation Area

- The company shall provide a clean, private, and secure lactation room (not a restroom) for breastfeeding or milk expression.

- The area shall be equipped with seating, a flat surface, electrical outlets (if applicable), and access to clean water.

3. Milk Storage

- Employees may store expressed milk in designated refrigerators or personal insulated containers.
- All stored milk must be properly labeled with the employee's name and date.

4. Work Arrangements

- Supervisors and managers are encouraged to support flexible scheduling, where feasible, to accommodate lactation needs without disrupting operations.

5. Hygiene and Cleanliness

- Employees must maintain cleanliness of the lactation area after use.
- Proper hygiene practices must be observed when expressing and storing milk.

6. Non-Discrimination

- The company strictly prohibits discrimination or harassment against employees who choose to breastfeed or express milk during work hours.

7. Awareness and Support

- The company will promote awareness of this policy and ensure supervisors are trained to support nursing employees.

Responsibilities:

- **Employees:** Coordinate schedules, maintain cleanliness, and follow proper storage practices.
- **Supervisors/Managers:** Provide reasonable support and ensure no disruption to business operations.
- **Company/HR:** Ensure availability of facilities and compliance with applicable laws.

Compliance:

This policy shall be implemented in accordance with applicable labor laws and health regulations.

Review:

This policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure effectiveness and compliance.

Family Welfare Program

Purpose:

EmpireOne recognizes the importance of supporting employees in balancing work and family responsibilities. The Family Welfare Program is designed to promote the well-being of employees and their immediate family members by providing support, resources, and programs that foster a healthy work-life balance.

Scope:

This policy applies to all employees, including officers, executives, managers, and staff.

Policy Details:

1. **Parental Support**
 - Maternity and paternity leave will be provided in accordance with applicable laws.
 - Employees may request flexible work arrangements when returning from parental leave.
2. **Childcare Assistance**
 - The company may provide access to childcare programs or resources, subject to availability and management approval.
3. **Health and Wellness**
 - Employees and their immediate family members may be eligible to participate in health and wellness programs sponsored by the company.
 - Access to counseling and mental health support is available through the Employee Assistance Program (EAP).
4. **Family Events and Activities**
 - The company may organize family-oriented events to encourage employee engagement and family involvement.
5. **Support in Emergencies**
 - Employees experiencing family emergencies may request special leave or flexible scheduling, subject to manager approval.

Responsibilities:

- Employees are encouraged to communicate their needs to HR to access program benefits.
- Supervisors and managers should facilitate employee participation in the program while ensuring operational requirements are met.

Review and Updates:

This policy will be periodically reviewed to ensure compliance with applicable laws and alignment with company goals.